



Deconstructing the Essential Standard

Clarifying what students must know and be able to do.

Why this meeting matters

Teams often think they agree on a standard until they start defining what proficiency actually looks like. This meeting creates shared clarity.

Meeting 6 · Wednesday, October 21, 2026 · 45 minutes

Focus	What exactly do we expect students to learn?
Leave with	Draft learning targets for the essential standard.

Agenda — step by step

Time	What the team does
0–5 min	Review norms and roles. Confirm who holds each role today and re-read your team norms together. Re-read your essential standard together.
5–15 min	Unpack it. Identify the key concepts, skills, vocabulary, and level of rigor.
15–35 min	Break into learning targets. Turn the standard into smaller, teachable, assessable targets.
35–43 min	Write "I can" statements. Put each target in student-friendly language.
43–45 min	Prioritize. Decide which targets matter most to assess.

Where we're going next → Meeting 7

Defining Proficiency — Agreeing on what "learned it" means.